

Chapel Hill Friends Meeting

Newsletter: Sixth Month, 2026



Monthly Query: *In what ways am I involved in the work of reconciliation among individuals, groups, and nations?*

Monthly Worship Tip from the M&W Committee: *Be sure to allow adequate time between spoken messages in meeting for worship, so that they may settle in the silence and be truly absorbed. In general, Friends counsel against speaking more than once in a meeting.*

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Monthly Calendar

First Sunday	• 8:15 - 9:15 am - Early worship in the meeting room • 9:30 - 10:30 am - Forum via Zoom • 11:00 am - 12:00 - Worship in the meeting room • 11:00 am - 12:00 - Online worship via Zoom • After meeting - Potluck in the schoolhouse
Second Sunday	• 8:15 - 9:15 am - Early worship in the meeting room • 9:30 - 10:30 am - Forum via Zoom • 11:00 am - 12:00 - Blended Meeting in the meeting room and via Zoom
Third Sunday	• 8:00 - 9:00 am - Early worship in the meeting room (reverts to 8:15 the following week) • 9:00 - 10:30 am - Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business via Zoom • 11:00 am - 12:00 - Worship in the meeting room • 11:00 am - 12:00 - Online worship via Zoom
Fourth Sunday	• Same as Second Sunday - Blended Meeting
Fifth Sunday	• Same as First Sunday, but without potluck



Upcoming Zoom Fora

<https://www.chapelhillfriends.org/forums.html>

June 7: Vegan SPICES: Why I feel obliged to veganism. Led by Kate Fitch

June 14: Peace & Justice Forum: The Earth Quaker Action Team (EQAT) & the [Never Vanguard Boycott](#), Led by Walter Hjelt Sullivan, a member of the EQAT Board

June 21: Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business (no forum)

June 28: Starting the Summer Series Discussions: Exploring the Meanings of the word "Light" (discussion topic subject to change)



Upcoming Events

Piedmont Friends Retreat & Annual Sessions, June 5 - 7

GATHERED in SPIRIT, NOURISHED in NATURE, NURTURED in COMMUNITY

2026 Piedmont Friends Retreat & Annual Sessions

Friday – Sunday, June 5-7 at Haw River State Park



Registration is open and closes for accommodations and meals on May 10th

<https://www.piedmontfriends.org/2026-retreat-annual-sessions>

Go to the above page to register and for updates

- The Retreat begins Friday afternoon. Enjoy the nature of Haw River State Park, north of Greensboro
- Friday evening Family Night Gathering: intergenerational games and open-mic Coffeehouse
- Saturday morning activities include nature walk, small group workshops and interest group conversations
- Saturday morning deeper-dive workshops with Right Sharing of World Resource's Tracy Hjelt-Sullivan: The Power of Enough and Raleigh Friends Meeting's Seeds of War/Seeds of Peace queries responding in Spirit to a world in distress
- Saturday afternoon's Annual Sessions, Piedmont Friends meeting for worship with attention to business
- Saturday evening: Family Contra/Folk Dancing, Fire Circle
- Sunday morning Singing, followed by Meeting for Worship
- A Full Program for Children and Youth (elementary; middle & high school)
- Peaceful nature trails, lake activities, swimming pool, fire circle, disc golf
- Comfortable motel accommodations, cabins for youth
- Thoughtfully prepared meals, accommodating special diets

Palestinian Extra Virgin Olive Oil (EVOO) at PF Retreat

Dear Friends,

Piedmont Friends have collaborated with Knoxville (TN) Meeting to provide a “shipment” of very high quality Palestinian Extra Virgin Olive Oil (EVOO) from West Bank Palestinian farmers. These bottles, 500ml, will be available for \$20, with \$4 going to support AFSC’s relief efforts in Gaza.

Orders are NOW being accepted.

The order form is available here:

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSc3o2W6RjsZZL39Nm5hU-KV4Rc72azpVtvrMRhBRiiUvQ_ITg/viewform?usp=dialog

Payment by cash or check will be accepted at the Retreat or online payments prior to the Retreat may be arranged.

Simply submit your order using the online form to reserve your bottles at the Retreat.

Knoxville’s non-profit project has been operating for 18 years offering extra virgin, organic, fair-trade oil that comes from farmer coops in the West Bank. Swannanoa Valley Friends and Raleigh Friends have been participating for some time.

The 2026 PF Retreat invites all Piedmont Friends to join in this action of solidarity and support for Palestinians.

2026 PF Retreat Planning Committee

[With appreciation to those who have been part of the transportation relay to bring the cases from Knoxville to Haw River State Park.]

Love as Action - Silent Vigils June 13-14, and July 4

Whitney Fry shares with Friends:

AFSC has been organizing [Love as Action](#) public witness vigils to stand up to current authoritarian actions. Thousands have joined and tens of thousands are seeing our messages of resistance, hope, and solidarity. Participating is relatively simple. Friends gather in public visible spaces for one hour of public quiet witness. AFSC will provide all of the materials needed, including an organizers toolkit, a worship guide, and posters. Upcoming Love as Action weekends will be on May 16-17 and June 13-14. AFSC is building towards a large national day of action on July 4 to declare an alternative vision for the next 250 years of our country. If anyone from CHFM would like to join this growing movement, please reach out to Whitney Fry at whitneyfry@gmail.com. To learn more, see afsc.org/love-action. And to read about Friends’ experience, click [here](#).

Quaker-led, Interfaith Immersion into Spirit and Identity, July 16-21

Quaker Harmon shares with Friends:

Amid the mist and quiet beauty of a mountaintop Costa Rican cloud forest, Earth & Ember invites spiritual seekers and contemplatives to explore how their lives can be rooted in compassion and peace—while still engaging with a world marked by injustice, greed, and cruelty. Each day offers centering practices, meaningful participation in our rainforest community, rich spiritual conversation, and the wisdom of local scientists, artists, and peacemakers.

Join us for five days of reflection, community, and renewal in the mountains that have inspired generations of Friends.

When: **July 16–21**

Where: **Monteverde, Costa Rica**

Focus: **Spirit, Creation, Community, and Peace**

Learn More & Register Here: <https://earthnember.com/>



Quakers in the World

Community Storytelling about Migration, Tues., June 23

Whitney Fry, founder of Flame Tree Story, shares with Friends:

Would you like to share a personal story for World Refugee Day, on June 23rd? Our prompt for this storytelling event is Courage, and we'd love to hear your story! *Do you have a migration story? When have you entered into the migration story of someone else? How did courage feature in your story?* Storytellers will each share a 5-minute true story on the prompt, and we'll coach you in advance to craft the story that's right for the moment. This event is co-hosted by [Flame Tree Story](#) and [Story First Design](#). If interested, please complete [this Google Form](#) by May 13th. For any questions, reach out to Whitney Fry at whitney@flametreestory.com.

Conscientious Objection for Teens

As a representative of Quaker House and the Quaker Religious Education Collaborative (QREC), Curt Torell led a 90-minute hybrid workshop three times, each at different sponsoring meetings in New York Yearly Meeting, on CO for Teens. The audience spanned all ages and had about 30+ at each session with about 6-8 in-person at the hosting meeting. Since Selective Service registration is about to become automatic and involuntary, this topic is getting increased attention.

Alice Carlton: Underground Encounter A Short Story

Types & Shadows, the journal of the Fellowship of Quaker in the Arts Spring 2026 issue has a [short story by Alice Carlton](#).



Announcements

Quaker House Report for May 28, 2026

Curt Torell shares with Friends:

The GI Rights Hotline has been very busy, recording over 400 calls per month, their highest ever. The increase includes more calls about conscientious objection and others about not following illegal orders, the boat bombings in the Caribbean, and the wars in Gaza, Lebanon, and Iran.

Quaker House has contracted with a social media consulting firm to improve our presence and effectiveness, including the web page, Facebook, and Instagram. The consultant advised us that most people who wish to contact us use their phones. The existing website is radically not phone friendly, with large blocks of text and no simple method of navigating. The consultant is also “optimizing” our online presence to make it easier to find on searches. We will let everyone know when the new site is online. This should make a big difference.

Quaker House has also started a new Substack e-newsletter, called *Reconnaissance*. The most recent postings have been entitled:

- Dreams of a New Draft: A Nightmare for Everyone
- The Kink in Hegseth's Crusade Scheme

- Dominionist Christians Seeking to Dominate the Military
- Illegal War, Illegal Assassination, Illegal Orders

Access the e-newsletters at <https://quakerhouse.substack.com/>

CFS Beloved Community Offerings this Coming Summer

Pam Schwingl shares with Friends:

From Carolina Friends School Beloved Community Institute:

UPCOMING WELLNESS AND TRANSFORMATIONAL TRAVEL-LEARNING PROGRAMS

Registration opens soon!

- **Quaker Journey**, a weeklong visit to the 17th-century roots of Quakerism in the breathtaking Lake District of Northern England. **2-9 August 2026**

You can see links for these and additional offerings at www.cfsnc.org/AdultEnrichment.



Personals

Looking for Affordable Housing

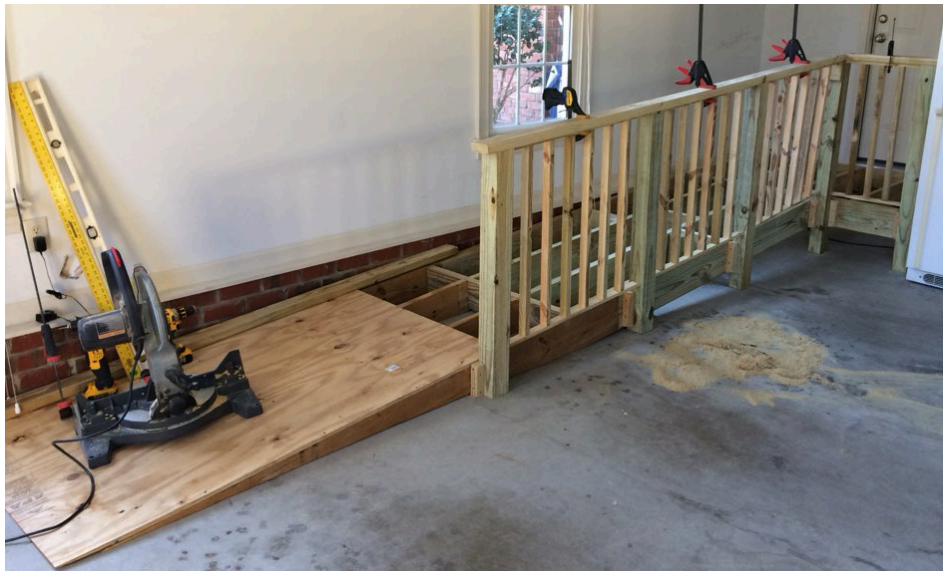
Maigan Kennedy shares with Friends:

I am looking for an affordable one-bedroom housing situation for myself, my 7-year-old daughter Nana, and our cat Mouse for the summer (or longer). We have been attending Meeting and First Day School since the beginning of the year. I am open to bartering (cooking/light housekeeping/yard work/childcare or eldercare/house sitting) services in exchange for all or part of our rent. I have excellent references. If you have any suggestions, please contact me at 704-654-2158.

Wheelchair Ramp Available

Ed Bowen shares with Friends:

This wheelchair ramp was for my wife, who has now passed away. I am planning to unscrew it and pull it apart. Wondering if anyone can use the materials or knows of a charity that could use them. Contact Ed Bowen at edinchapelhill@gmail.com.



Home for Sale

Allie Scales shares with Friends:

My much loved home in the Kirkwood community is for sale. Two bed, three bathrooms, and lots of bonuses, not least, glorious sunsets, and neighbor to Matt and Lynn Drake! Easy reach of CHFM, and lots of neighborhood amenities.

https://www.zillow.com/homedetails/104-Homewood-Dr-Chapel-Hill-NC-27514/50051796_zpid/





Recurring Announcements

InterFath Council Committee Is Seeking Volunteers

We invite anyone interested in becoming, or knowing more about being an IFC Committee Member to please contact Carolyn White.

We welcome volunteers to help with food preparation and service at ICF every second Thursday for lunch: 10a - 1p, and/or every second Friday for dinner 4p-6:30p. Volunteers are welcome for part of the shift, or the full shift.

Zoom Tech Hosts Wanted

Support Chapel Hill Friends Meeting's Zoom worship and forums by becoming a tech host. The role is much more simple than you would imagine. Trust us! We need your help and will train you. Please contact the Zoom Subcommittee if interested, or have questions:

zoom@chapelhillfriends.org.

Inter-Faith Council Pantry Needs Donated Food Items

Please consider IFC's needs when doing your shopping. There is a basket in the meetinghouse foyer for food donations. IFC has requested the following food items: coffee, hot chocolate, canned protein, canned pork and beans, canned soup (not vegetable), boxed cereal, cake mixes, instant foods, ramen noodles. Thank you!

FRIENDS, PLEASE LIMIT YOUR WEEKDAY MEETINGHOUSE VISITS.

The CFS Early School teachers, parents and guests have priority use of the meetinghouse parking lot from 7:30 AM to 6:00 PM Monday through Friday throughout the calendar year. If you must visit the meetinghouse during weekday hours, please alert John Hite, the Meetinghouse Resident, at least one day ahead. Email: johnthequaker@gmail.com or call: 919-929-5377.

Newsletter & eNews Reminder

Please send items for the weekly eNews email and the monthly print Newsletter to news@chapelhillfriends.org.

- The deadline for weekly eNews is *Wednesday* 5 pm.
- The deadline for the monthly print Newsletter is on the *last day of the month*.

To unsubscribe, email to news@chapelhillfriends.org with the subject line, Unsubscribe.

Note: If you think that you haven't received your weekly enews or monthly newsletter, it helps to add news@chapelhillfriends.org to your contacts. Otherwise it might go to your Spam folder (and likewise for other chapelhillfriends.org mailing lists such as pfym@chapelhillfriends.org).



Recurring Events

Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light, 2nd and 4th Wednesday, 7-8:30 pm

YOU ARE INVITED TO PARTICIPATE IN Virtual Prayers for Healing/Holding in the Light on the 2nd and 4th Wednesday of each month, 7:00 to 8:30 PM. Join us when you can for as long as you wish - from your own home.

Do you have a name or a group of people to add to - or remove from - the list of those we will hold in our hearts and prayers? If so, please send to: prayers@chapelhillfriends.org. The list of names to be held in the Light will be renewed each month. Names must be resubmitted each month to be maintained on the list. We'll send an updated list on Wednesday afternoons. Thank you for joining us!

This virtual prayer service continues under the care of the Care and Counsel Committee and each week, a committee member will collect and post the names that are submitted and will read them aloud during the time of the service.

Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine. Thursdays, 5:30pm

You are invited to join Meeting for Worship with Attention to Peace in Palestine and Israel at 5:30 p.m. ET / 2:30 p.m. PT.

Join on Zoom:

<https://afsc-org.zoom.us/j/85831333364?pwd=VEtPTUZuYk5hTHV2OGs1VzRkY0ZKUT09>

Meeting ID: 858 3133 3364

Passcode: 759311

Pendle Hill Worship via Zoom, Daily, 8:30-9:10am

Pendle Hill Quaker Study, Retreat, and Conference Center is now opening their daily morning worship to everyone, by way of Zoom or phone. A lovely opportunity for gathered worship every morning. "A handful of Pendle Hill residents continue to gather daily in the Barn – from 8:30am to 9:10am Eastern Time – expanding the 90-year-long tradition of daily worship here on campus. Beginning the week of March 16, 2020, we started an experiment of opening the circle of worship to YOU in your home. You can join us here via Zoom."

<https://pendlehill.org/explore/worship/join-us-online-for-worship-in-the-barn/?bblinkid=210290749&bbemailid=19903873&bbejrid=1408822779>

Note: The above link takes you *not* to the meeting but to a page of general instructions. Look for the sentence "You can join us via Zoom **here**, or by clicking on the image below."

Pray for Peace - From Friends House Moscow, Daily

Link to the Daily Meeting for Worship for Peace sponsored by FHM/FHMSA: (Friends House Moscow)

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/4165005614?pwd=NUtieEtqbDBYbjBrcGdMMzBKQ3drQT09>

Meeting ID: 416 500 5614

Passcode: 182805

The room opens at 8:45am Pacific time (10:45 EST); worship begins on the hour and ends an hour later. After worship there will be time to share brief thoughts that did not rise to the level of ministry. You may also want to rename yourself indicating your geographic location. There will be no audible indicator when one enters or leaves, and everyone will be muted on entry. Please leave yourself muted unless giving ministry.

Ministry may also be shared in the chat, but it is not the place for private conversations. If you are new to Quaker unprogrammed worship and wish to talk with someone about it, send a message to the host and someone can join you in a breakout room.



Business Meeting Minutes

Chapel Hill Friends Meeting

Minutes of the May 17, 2026, Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business, online via Zoom

Attendance: Jeff Brown, Quaker Harmon, Jennifer Leeman, Lynn & Matt Drake, Elias North, Hart Pillow, David Waterman, Herb Derby, Carolyn Stuart, Tony Hickey, Traci & Walter Hjelt Sullivan, Barry & Lynda Mackichan, Buzz Borchardt, Tom Ludlow, Tom Munk, Wendy Michener, Astra Titus, Monteze Snyder, Lloyd Kramer, Alice Carlton, Dave Curtin, Allie Scales, Jan Hutton, Melissa Ruof, Colleen Fey, John Hite, Betsy Brinson, Julia Cleaver, Susan Newcomer, Gwynne Pomeroy, Ann Miller, Dottie Heninger, Hank Elkins, Evelyn Fender-Lee, Nancy Milio

1. We opened with worship and the query: How do I recognize the needs and gifts of each member of my family and household, not forgetting my own?
2. We welcomed Elias North as a first-time attender at Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business.
3. Friends approved the Minutes of the April 2026 Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business as written.
4. Jeff Brown, Clerk, presented Finance committee's proposal for the distribution of the Legacy benevolences for 2025-26, which follow Meeting guidelines for the percentage allotted to each organization. The guidelines apply for a five-year period after which we will reconsider. Friends approved the proposed distribution as follows:

Quaker House	\$6,642 (27%)
American Friends Service Committee	\$1,230 (5%)
Carolina Friends School	\$4,182 (17%)
Friends Committee on National Legislation	\$1,968 (8%)
Inter Faith Counsel	\$5,658 (23%)
Total legacy	\$19,680 (80% of benevolences)

5. David Waterman, Clerk of Finance Committee, presented the Draft Budget for fiscal year 2026-27 ([Appendix A](#)). The proposal includes a 6% increase in proposed expenditures. Among other things, the increase includes funding for a tech host to support blended meetings. Friends raised the following recommendations/concerns:

- A recommendation was made to fundraise specifically for the tech host position.

- A recommendation was made to review the amount of contributions raised in previous years. Last year's information was shared indicating that we raised sufficient funds to cover the increase.
- Questions were raised about the budget for the tech host position and how the number of hours was determined. Those numbers were determined based on discussions in both the Zoom and Ministry and Worship committees. The amount in the budget represents a best estimate. The final cost will depend on further decision making about the number of blended meetings (worship, forum, and business meeting) will be held in the coming year. In addition, we are not sure when will hire the tech host but it will likely be after the start of the new fiscal year.
- A question was raised about whether we could use carry over money from this year to cover the coming year budget. This is not our practice. Our practice is that finance brings a recommendation for how to designate carry forward for the meeting's approval. That recommendation will be brought forward in September or October of 2026.
- A question was raised as to whether we have funds allocated for the purchase of new sound equipment. We have a building renovation fund that can be used for sound improvements.

Friends expressed gratitude to Finance Committee for their work on the budget. Approval of the final budget will be held over to June.

6. John Hite presented the Nominations Committee report and the list of proposed nominees for 2026-27 ([Appendix B](#)). Edits to term limits and spelling were made in the document during the meeting. Tom Munk noted that he was on one too many committees and asked that Nominations remove him from one. Herb Derby expressed an interest in joining Finance Committee. A Friend expressed gratitude for the number of new F/friends joining committees. Friends thanked nominations for their work. The list of nominees will be held over for approval in the June meeting.

7. On behalf of Peace & Justice Committee, Tom Munk presented our Meeting's recommended revisions to the priorities for Friends Committee on North Carolina Legislation ([Appendix C](#)). These revisions resulted from a forum. Tom Munk and Kathy Lucente incorporated input from the forum into the document, which was then reviewed and approved by the Peace & Justice Committee. Friends approved the recommended revisions with gratitude for Tom and Kathy's work.

8. Tom Munk provided an update on Peace & Justice Committee's recent communication with U.S. Representative Foushee. On May 11, Tom sent an email to Rep. Foushee's office thanking her for the many positive things she has done recently and again asking for a response to the Meeting's request to condemn actions in Gaza ([Appendix D](#)). Her office responded to say that she was too busy to meet but that her Deputy Chief of Staff could meet with representatives from the Meeting. Tom reported that he will follow-up to confirm a date for that meeting and asked F/friends to let him know if they were interested in participating.

9. Tom Ludlow reported on a June 7th Peace & Justice Committee forum on climate change, divestment, and other potential actions. Walter Hjelt Sullivan will lead the forum, which will include discussion of EQAT (Earth Quaker Action Team) and its Never Vanguard initiative.

10. Jeff Brown read a letter requesting membership from Taylor Schmidt. Taylor's request will be referred to Ministry & Worship to establish a clearness committee.

11. The next Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business is planned for 9:00 AM on June 21, 2026.

12. We closed with worship.

Jeff Brown, Clerk, and Jennifer Leeman, Recording Clerk

Appendix A: Finance Committee Proposed Budget for 2026-2027

Proposed Operating Budget for FY 2026-27			Proposed	\$	%	% of Total
		2025-26	2026-27	Increase/	Increase/	2026-27
		Budget	Budget	Decrease	Decrease	Budget
Income						
	Building Rental	0	0			
	Contributions	82,286	88,065	5,779	7%	92%
	Parking: 2025 games (6 x \$1200)	7,200	7200	0	0%	8%
Total Income		89,486	95,265	5,779	6%	100%
Expenses						
A-Obligations						
	Accountant	7,500	7,800	300	4%	
	Servant Keeper Giving Fees	1,000	1,000	0	0%	
	FDS Coordinator/Childcare	8,668	9,854	1,186	14%	
	Insurance & workers' comp	15,458	16,176	718	5%	
	Software Licenses	2,485	3,623	1,138	46%	
	UBIT (parking taxes)	1296	2000	704	54%	
	Storm Water Fees	565	565	0	0%	
	Utilities	5,392	5,734	342	6%	
	Zoom operator	3,622	4,113	491	14%	
Total A-Obligations		45,986	50,865	4,879	11%	53%
B-Committees						
	Adult Religious Ed	100	500	400	400%	
	Building and Grounds	11,360	13,000	1,640	14%	
	Care and Counsel					
		Mtng for Suffering	200	200	0	0%
		C&C Committee	100	100	0	0%
	Total Care and Counsel	300	300	0	0%	
	Children's/Youth Religious Ed	200	200	0	0%	
	Communication Technology	500	500	0	0%	
	Finance	300	300	0	0%	
	Friends Transition & Sunst-Yoke	600	600	0	0%	
	Hospitality	250	250	0	0%	
	IFC	150	150	0	0%	
	Library	350	350	0	0%	
	Ministry and Worship	600	1,000	400	67%	
	Nominations	40	0	-40	-100%	
	Peace and Justice					
		Nat'l Quaker Serv.	1,500	0	-1,500	-100%
		P&J Committee	500	500	0	0%
	Total Peace and Justice	2,000	500	-1,500	-75%	
	Publications and Communications	750	750	0	0%	
Total B-Committees		17,500	18,400	900	5%	19%
C-Core Quaker Commitments (M&W)		1,400	1,400	0	0%	1%
D-Benevolences						
	Legacy	19,680	19,680	0	0%	
	Discretionary	4,920	4,920	0	0%	
Total D-Benevolences		24,600	24,600	0	0%	26%
TOTAL Expenses		89,486	95,265	5,779	6%	100%
2025-26 Benevolence/Core Quaker commitment detail						
	Legacy		Core			
	Quaker House 26.8% (rounding: 27%)		Friends Journal \$200			
	AFSC 5% (rounding: 5%)		Piedmont Friends Yearly Meeting \$350			
	CF5 – Tuition Aid 17.5% (rounding: 17%)		Friends General Conference \$600			
	FCNL 7.4% (rounding: 8%)		Friends for LGBTQ Concerns \$100			
	IFC 22.3% (rounding: 23%)					
	Discretionary					
	FCNL \$100					
	Ramallah Friends School \$1425					
	Bridging the Gap: \$1425					
	Orange County Coalition for Remembrance \$540					
	Orange-Alamance Prison Ministry \$1425					

Appendix B: Nominations Committee Annual Report 2026

The Nominations Committee seeks to identify and call forth the gifts and talents of attenders and members of our Meeting for service within the Meeting and in the larger community. Throughout the year, the committee works with other Meeting committees to identify the interests and skills needed for committees to fulfill their missions. The committee initiates the search for nominees, often asking other committees and individual members of the Meeting community to help identify likely candidates. The Nominations Committee seeks to align the gifts and interests of individuals with the work of Meeting committees and of organizations receiving Meeting appointees.

The Committee brings nominations for vacancies in Meeting committees and appointees for the next program year (July-June) to the May Meeting for Worship with Attention to Business (MWAB) for review. Nominations presents a final report to the June MWAB.

Nominations also identifies appropriate members and attenders to fill position vacancies as they occur. The Committee reviews the Recording Clerk, Treasurer, Recorder, Correspondence Clerk, and Trustee positions as the terms are due to be completed. The Committee also organizes a discernment process to recommend a new Meeting Clerk every three years prior to completion of the Meeting Clerk's term.

Each Fall, the Meeting Clerk identifies a Naming Committee consisting of Meeting members and attenders and brings the Friends' names to the MWAB for approval. The Naming Committee recommends to MWAB the names of Friends to serve on the Nominations Committee.

This year we worked diligently to meet the various requests/needs of the numerous committees. We enjoy working together as a team.

Our current slate of nominees follows.

Respectfully submitted,

John Hite, Clerk, Alice Carlton, Lori Fernald Khamala, Matt Drake, Quaker Harmon, Buzz Borchardt

Slate of nominees for 2026-27

Position	Named Roles	Term #	Term Ends
Clerk	Jeff Brown	1	2028
Recording Clerk	Jennifer Leeman	1	2027
Treasurer	Ann Miller	1	2029
Trustee	Marie Hopper	3	2029
Trustee	Matt Drake	3	2029
Trustee	Lloyd Kramer	3	2027
Recorder	Carolyn White	4	2028
Corresponding Clerk	Dottie Heninger	3	2027

1. CFS Board		
Friend (CHFM Appointee)	Term #	Term Ends
Laura Young	2	2027
Eric Graves	2	2027
Rob Jones	1	2027
Tony Hickey	1	2029

2. Quaker House Board		
Friend (CHFM Appointee)	Term #	Term Ends
Rufus King	2	2027
Curt Torrell	2	2028
Lori Khamala	1	2027

3. Piedmont Friends Yearly Meeting and Fellowship		
Friend (CHFM Appointee)	Term #	Term Ends
Leslie Rountree	3	2028
Tom Munk	1	2029
Jennifer Leeman	1	2029

4. Friends Committee on NC Legislation		
Friend (CHFM Appointee)	Term #	Term Ends
Tom Munk	1	2029
Elias North	1	2029
Carolyn White	1	2029
Wendy Michener	2	2029

5. Coalition of Clergy		
Friend (CHFM Appointee)	Term #	Term Ends
Carolyn White	1	2028
Ann Miller	1	2028

6. Adult Religious Education		
Kate Fitch*	2	2027
John Bell	2	2027
Campo Larrick	2	2029
Leslie Bassinger	1	2027
Walter Hjelt Sullivan	1	2028
Kate White	1	2029
Taylor Schmidt	1	2029

7. Buildings and Grounds		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
John Hite*, Resident		
Naveed Moeed*	2	2029
Cecelia King	1	2027
Peter Malone	2	2027
Eric Feickert	1	2028
Ken Bassinger	1	2027
Jessie Eustice	1	2028
Damien Rochford	1	2029
Caroline Carmen, CFES head teacher		Ex-officio

8. Care and Counsel		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
Alice Carlton*	2	2028
Tom Munk	2	2028
Bonnie Raphael	2	2028
Richard Miller	1	2027
Eloise Grathwohl	1	2029
Emilie Condon	1	2028
Margaret Vimmerstedt	1	2029
Tony Hickey	1	2029
Madelyn Ashley	1	2029
Jeff Brown, Clerk of Meeting		Ex-officio

9. Children & Youth Religious Education		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
Rob Jones*	2	2027
Leslie Rountree	2	2027
Tom Munk	1	2027
Maigan Kennedy	1	2029
Kathy Lucente	1	2029
Dan Hill	1	2029
Stacie Sewell		Ex-Officio
Kathleen McNeil, FDS Coordinator		Ex-Officio

10. Finance		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
David Waterman*	2	2028
Julia Cleaver*	2	2028
Tom Ludlow	2	2028
Mansir Petrie	2	2027
Susan Newcomer	2	2029
Lynda MacKichan	1	2028
Evelyn Lee	1	2028
Wendy Michener	1	2028
Herb Derby	1	2029
Ann Miller	Treasurer Ex-officio	

11. Hospitality		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
Quaker Harmon*	2	2028
Pam Schwingl	2	2028
Susan Peterson	2	2029
Madelyn Ashley	1	2028
Traci Hjelt Sullivan	1	2028
Mark Toles	1	2028
Betsy Brinson	1	2029
Marion Schoenbach	1	2029

12. IFC		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
Tori Toles*	2	2027
Betsy Brinson	2	2029
John Bell	1	2027
Lynn Wilson	1	2027
Deborah Gibbs	1	2027
Marion Schoenbach	1	2028
Carolyn Stuart	1	2028
Linda Patterson	1	2029
Alexis Gilmore	1	2028

13. Library		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
David Curtin *	3	2027
Lloyd Kramer	2	2028
Allie Scales	2	2028
John Hite	2	2029
Annalee Harkins	1	2028
Jessica Harper	1	2027
Leslie Bassinger	1	2027
Herb Derby	1	2028

14. Ministry and Worship		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
Dottie Heninger*	2	2027
Jasmine McKewen	2	2028
Lloyd Kramer	2	2029
Deborah Gibbs	1	2027
Julia Cleaver	1	2027
Tom Ludlow	1	2027
John Pilgrim	1	2028
Melissa Ruof	1	2029
Fran Palmieri	1	2029
Clerk of Meeting		Ex-Officio

15. Nominations		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
John Hite*	2	End of 2029
Buzz Borchardt	1	End of 2028
Quaker Harmon	2	End of 2029
Lori Khamala	2	End of 2029
Matt Drake	2	End of 2029

16. Peace and Justice		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
Astra Titus*	2	2028
Tom Ludlow*	1	2028
Barry Mackichan	1	2028
Lydia Kiefer	1	2028
Jenn Bills	1	2028
Tom Munk	1	2028

17. Publications and Communications		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
Sean Chen*	5	2028
David Curtin	5	2026
Buzz Borchardt	3	2027
Barry Mackichan	1	2028
Heath Sledge	1	2028
Maigan Kennedy	1	2029

18. Returning Citizens Financial Assistance (ReCFAC)		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
Ann Shy*	2	2027
Nancy Milio	4	2027
Gwynne Pomeroy	4	2027
Sally Fisher	1	2029

19. Shotts Leadership Fund		
Friend	Term #	Term Ends
Jan Hutton*	3	2029
Jessica Harper	1	2027
Madelyn Ashley	1	2027
Roberto Quercia	6	2029
Loren Hintz	1	2029
Julie Feickert	1	2029

20. Transition & Support		
Friend		
Tom McQuiston*	5	2028
Sally Fisher*	1	2027
Hank Elkins	5	2029
Annette Broadwell	2	2027
Ronnie Harris	1	2027
Melissa Ruof	1	2029

GIVERS OF TIME & SERVICE

21. Zoom
Friend
Quaker Harmon
Buzz Borchardt
Jeff Brown
John Hite
Dave Curtin
Herb Derby
Barry Mackichan
Tom Ludlow

GIVERS OF TIME & SERVICE

22. First Day School Teachers	
Friend	
Stacey Sewall	Nursery & Pre-kindergarten
Kathleen McNeil (FDS Director)	Children
Jasmine McKewen	Children
Carolyn White	Children
Kathy Lucente	Children
Gwynne Pomeroy	Children
Leslie Rountree	Children
Mark Hulbert	Children
Julie Feickert	Children
Cecilia King	Children
Maigan Kennedy	Children/Upper Pod
John Hite	Upper Pod
Rob Jones	Upper Pod
Tom Munk	Upper Pod

Appendix C: Recommended Revisions to the FCNCL Priorities

THESE POLICY PRIORITIES WERE APPROVED AT THE FCNCL GENERAL COMMITTEE ANNUAL MEETING, OCTOBER 5, 2024.

(Additions are italicized)

Health and Safety of All North Carolina Residents

Led by the Quaker testimonies of Equality and Community we call for legislation that will improve individual health, including mental health, and safety of all residents of North Carolina. We support the rights of individuals in consultation with their doctors to full access to medical care and decisions without stigma or legal repercussions. We also recognize that many of the gaps that currently exist in health and safety fall disproportionately on marginalized populations.

We support:

- expanding healthcare coverage to all, including continued closure of the Medicaid coverage gap and improvements in NC healthcare systems and staffing;
- protecting choice in reproductive health care, *including not funding centers that do not provide ALL options to women searching for reproductive health*;
- expanding paid family leave for public employees;
- protecting coverage for gender affirming care in line with doctor recommendations;
- supporting regulations that restrict access to firearms and improve gun safety;
- promoting food justice and food security;
- protecting the health and safety of workers, *unhoused people* ~~the homeless~~, and undocumented immigrants.

Environment

Led by the Quaker testimony of Stewardship for the Earth and in support of the Piedmont Friends Yearly Meeting Minute on Climate Change, we support the vital protection of our earth and healthy biosystems through the promotion of clean energy and clean air and water, taking care not to disproportionately burden vulnerable communities in the pursuit of these goals.

We Support:

- addressing of the climate crisis by: stimulating greater investment in renewables and other non-fossil fuel energy ~~generating~~ sources, pension fund investments in

clean, sustainable energy, enhanced public transportation (*e.g. light rail*), and protection of NC coastal communities;

- improving air and water quality and protecting waterways by imposing restrictions on concentrated animal feeding operations (CAFOs);
- cleaning up polluted waterways and water supplies (e.g., coal ash, PFAS (forever chemicals)) and holding responsible corporations accountable;
- protecting ecological systems (e.g., wetlands, *forests, diversity*);
- strengthening systems for recycling and composting;
- enabling localities to impose environmental protections (e.g., tree protection, restricting plastic bags);
- addressing the environmental impact of data centers for AI;
- preparing vulnerable communities for the impact of climate change and severe weather.

Education

Led by our testimonies of Equality, Integrity, and Community, we value the importance of education in realizing the inherent potential of all people.

We Support:

- legislation that ensures equal access to constitutionally required quality public education;
- additional funding for pre-K through college for all residents;
- instruction which centers integrity and truth-seeking, provided by qualified staff; and infrastructure that ensures the mental and physical health, safety, and dignity of all involved;
- state curriculum standards for public, charter, and private schools developed by educational experts that are inclusive of all NC residents and that include a racial justice lens;
- full funding for public schools as opposed to funding of private school vouchers;
- *full funding of the Leandro-based [Action Plan for NC](#) created by WestEd;*
- *increases in teacher pay;*
- *restoration of classroom assistants;*
- local school boards that are representative of the whole community.

Democracy

Stemming from our testimonies of Integrity, Equality, and Community, we recognize that a strong democratic process with inclusion and respect for all is a central foundation for living in the free world. We advocate for a strong democracy including an open, transparent government, and citizen input throughout the legislative process.

We Support:

- voting rights that provide equity to all citizens, including access to early voting, *mail-in ballots*, and assurances that all votes will be fairly counted and reported;
- *joining the national popular vote compact for president and vice president*
<https://www.nationalpopularvote.com/>;
- true democratic reforms of our still flawed election system
- non-partisan redistricting to address problems in gerrymandering;
- efforts to enhance the peaceful resolution of conflicts, with respect for those with whom we disagree;
- *protection of journalism because a free press is essential for democracy;*
- *a public records law that includes the legislature;*
- civics lessons on our democratic processes as a secondary school requirement.

We reject all efforts to undermine the democratic process

Criminal Legal Justice Reform

Led by the Quaker testimonies of Peace and Equality we support a justice system that treats all persons with equal dignity and respect.

We Support:

- elimination of cash bail for low-level crimes;
- elimination of the death penalty;
- enhanced police training in racial equity and a no-hire list for officers who harass people of color;
- *statewide expansion ~~creation~~ of co-responder (e.g. Chapel Hill PD's social workers) and alternative responder (e.g. Durham's [HEART](#)), response teams to address mental health and non-criminal emergencies;*
- creation of a uniform code of prisoner rights including fair sentencing, fair wages and education in prison;
- increased resources for community re-entry programs;
- *elimination of solitary confinement;*
- legal protections for *people experiencing homelessness and with psychiatric disorders* ~~the homeless and the mentally ill~~;
- *significant and continuing reductions in the number of people incarcerated in jails, prisons, and detention centers (e.g. decriminalization of personal marijuana use and other offenses, elimination of cash bail, reduced sentencing, pretrial diversion programs, restorative justice alternatives, and more)*

Appendix D. Correspondence with Representative Foushee's Office

I write because we in Action for Gaza, together with the Chapel Hill Friends Meeting Peace and Justice Committee, are constituents of Rep. Foushee who would like to continue our conversations with her about the Middle East.

We have several specific topics.

- 1) Thank you again for your votes on resolutions to get aid to the suffering families of Gaza, particularly via UNRWA.
- 2) Thank you again for your vote in favor of the resolution to stop sending weapons to Israel.
- 3) And, most recently, thank you for co-sponsoring Rep. Tlaib's War Powers Resolution opposing all U.S. military involvement in Israel's hostilities in Lebanon. We are very grateful for and in full agreement with your April 9 statement on X: "I am signing @RepRashida's War Powers Resolution to stop all U.S. military involvement in Israel's hostilities in Lebanon. The war in Lebanon has displaced nearly 1 million people and has claimed the lives of thousands. Our federal government must hold itself to higher humanitarian standards than participating in a war that is putting innocent people at risk."
- 4) Can we hear from you regarding our request that you co-sponsor Rep. Tlaib's resolution recognizing genocide in Gaza?
- 5) Finally, can you co-sponsor one of the resolutions that will stop funding for the unprovoked and illegal U.S. attacks on Iran? We are aware of two: Val Hoyle's HR 8592 and No Funds for Iran War, sponsored by Pat Ryan (no number yet).

Might we talk with Rep. Foushee, or with you, in one of the following ways?

- 1) Best Choice. Rep. Foushee joins the Chapel Hill Friends Meeting on Zoom for one of our weekly Forums to talk about ways we can stop rampant U.S. militarism in the Middle East (and elsewhere). We usually have about 30 participants, but might expect twice as many if Rep. Foushee would join us.
- 2) Second Best. Rep. Foushee meets with five to ten of us in person at her Durham office during the Memorial Day break.
- 3) Third Best. Rep. Foushee meets with ten or twenty of us via Zoom at the time of her convenience, before or during the Memorial Day break.
- 4) Another option would be to have one of these engagements with you, Sarah.

Tom Munk, Tom Ludlow, and Astra Titus (clerks)

for Action for Gaza and the Chapel Hill Friends Meeting Peace and Justice Committee

Chapel Hill Monthly Meeting of the Religious Society of Friends

531 Raleigh Road, Chapel Hill, NC 27514

Resident: John Hite (919) 929-5377